

COMP170 Introduction to Object-Oriented Programming

INSTRUCTOR INFORMATION

Instructor Name: Christopher Fulton

Instructor Email: cfulton@luc.edu

Online Office Hours: All appointments are available upon request to provide greater flexibility. Please email me if you would like to schedule an individual session. The final 15 minutes of each class session will be devoted to addressing questions, ideas, and concerns.

COURSE INFORMATION

Course Start Date: 08/17/2026

Course End Date: 10/10/2026

Course Meeting Times: Wednesday 6 pm – 8:30 pm

Course Location: This is an 8-week, fully online synchronous course via Zoom. The Zoom link is available in Brightspace.

Course Website: Brightspace is a learning management system in which all course materials will be hosted. All lecture slides, assignment write-ups, course content, and learning materials will be posted in Brightspace. The link below will take you to this semester's course site.

<https://brightspace.luc.edu/d2l/home/19052>

Course Description and Learning Outcomes:

This programming-intensive course introduces basic concepts of object-oriented programming in a language such as Java.

Outcomes: Ability to take a problem, break it into parts, specify algorithms, and express a solution in terms of variables, data types, input/output, repetition, choice, arrays, subprograms, classes, and objects; ability to judge a good program.

Course Objectives:

Upon successful completion of this course, students will be able to:

- I. Analyze and explain the behavior of simple programs involving the following fundamental programming constructs: assignment, I/O (including file I/O), selection, iteration/loops, and methods.
- II. Write a program that uses each of the following fundamental programming constructs: assignment, I/O (including file I/O), selection, iteration, and methods.
- III. Break a problem into logical pieces that can be solved (programmed) independently.
- IV. Develop and analyze algorithms for solving simple problems. Apply appropriate problem-solving strategies.
- V. Write programs that use each of the following data structures (and briefly describe how they are represented in memory): strings and arrays.
- VI. Use a suitable programming language, and development environment, to implement, test, and debug algorithms for solving simple problems.

- VII. Use a development environment to design, code, test, and debug simple programs, including multi-file source projects, in an object-oriented programming language.
- VIII. Implement basic error handling.
- IX. Use APIs (Application Programmer Interfaces); standard Java APIs.

PRE/COREQUISITE COURSE(S)

Prerequisite: MATH 118 or Placement or COMP 125 or COMP 141 or COMP 150 or COMP 180 or permission or SCPS student. Prior experience with a procedural programming language is sufficient to obtain permission to enroll.

REQUIRED TEXTBOOKS

For this course, we will use a web-based textbook called Codio. Please create an account and purchase the book at your earliest convenience (preferably before our first-class session). Instructions for obtaining the book are provided below.

1. Sign in or create an account at <https://codio.com/p/signup?courseToken=voltage-survive-boxer-greek>
2. Subscribe to the course subscription by creating an account.

A subscription is \$48. Students may subscribe at your earliest convenience, and the subscription typically lasts 5 months.

LEARNER SUPPLIES

Listed below are the items you will need for our course:

- **GitHub Account** - Your GitHub Account will host your assignments and labs for the course. During the first week of class, we will walk through how to create a GitHub account and publish your work.
- **Internet Access and Google Chrome browser** - Access to high-speed internet is critical and essential for our weekly online synchronous sessions. In addition to internet access, you will need to have the Google chrome browser installed. You can find more information about the browser installation at the link below
 - <https://www.google.com/chrome/downloads/>
- **Reliable Computer and Webcam**—Because our course is online and technical in nature, your computer is expected to have the specifications to install software and be able to utilize a webcam.

GRADING SCALE

Letter Grade/Percentage Equivalents for SCPS:

A 100% - 95%	B 86% - 88%	C 77% - 79%	D 65% - 70%
A- 92% - 94%	B- 83% - 85%	C- 74% - 76%	F <65%
B+ 89% - 91%	C+ 80% - 82%	D+ 71% - 73%	

GRADING RATIONALE

- Programs = 50% of final grade | 6 Programs (25 points each)
- Quizzes = 20% | 6 Quizzes (10 points each)
- Codio Readings/Lab = 13.33% | 8 Codio Assignments/Readings (5 total points)
- Exams = 16.66% | 1 Final Exam (50 Points)

Total Possible Points: 300

FORMATIVE ASSESSMENT

Program (1 - 5), Quizzes, Codio Readings/Lab

SUMMATIVE ASSESSMENT

Program 6, Final Exam

SCHEDULE

Session/	Course Outcome(s)	Topics/Activities	Assessment(s)
Week 1	CO I, CO VII	Introductions and Syllabus Review Download and Install JDK Configuring/Writing/Compiling/Analyzing /Executing a Java Program Codio Reading/Lab: Module 1	Program 1 Released Codio Assignment Due (8/21)
Week 2	CO II, CO IX	Understanding Branching/Selection Structure Codio Reading/Lab: Module 2	Program 1 Due (8/30) Program 2 Released Codio Assignment Due (8/26)
Week 3	CO III, VIII	Control Structures – Looping Exception Handling Codio Reading/Lab: Module 3	Program 2 Due (9/6) Program 3 Released Codio Assignment Due (9/2)
Week 4	CO V	Static Data Structures - Arrays, Multidimensional Arrays Codio Reading/Lab: Module 4	Program 3 Due (9/13) Program 4 Released Codio Assignment Due (9/9)
Week 5	CO VII	Modularization - Method Structure and Formation Introduction to OOP - Classes Codio Reading/Lab: Module 5	Program 4 Due (9/20) Program 5 Released Codio Assignment Due (9/16)

Week 6	CO VII	Introduction to Object-Oriented Programming - Classes continued Input/Output Codio Reading/Lab: Module 6	Program 5 Due (9/27) Program 6 Released Codio Assignment Due (9/23)
Week 7	CO VI	Dynamic Data Structures – Collections Introduction to Object-Oriented Programming - Inheritance Codio Reading/Lab: Module 7	Codio Assignment Due (9/30)
Week 8	CO VII	Introduction to Object-Oriented Programming – Abstract Classes, Interfaces Codio Reading/Lab: Module 8	Program 6 Due (10/7) Codio Assignment Due (10/7) Final Exam (10/7)

ATTENDANCE

Attendance and active participation are required for all synchronous class sessions. All required sessions are listed below.

- August 19, 2026, 6 pm – 8:30 pm
- August 26, 2026, 6 pm – 8:30 pm
- September 2, 2026, 6 pm – 8:30 pm
- September 9, 2026, 6 pm – 8:30 pm
- September 16, 2026, 6 pm – 8:30 pm
- September 23, 2026, 6 pm – 8:30 pm
- September 30, 2026, 6 pm – 8:30 pm
- October 7, 2026, 6 pm – 8:30 pm

SUCCEEDING IN THIS CLASS

As the instructor, my job in this class is to organize the material coherently, give helpful lectures, provide a framework that combines enough challenge and support for success, and grade reasonably. A reasonable academic expectation is that you spend 2 hours outside of class for every hour spent in class. For a few of your assignments, you may go over this time estimate.

- Complete the assigned reading and review material before each class session.
- Take notes and participate in the learning/coding activities found in the slide presentations
- Complete labs and assignments to the best of your ability

LATE WORK POLICY

All programs must be submitted by the due date and time listed on the program. If the program is not turned in by the due date and time listed, the program will not receive points and will be assessed at zero.

Students can receive up to 3 consecutive days beyond the original due date if the student notifies the instructor that an extension is needed before the due date listed on the program. Once the extension expires, the program will automatically receive a zero if not submitted within 3 consecutive days beyond the original due date. Program extensions will not be permitted if the instructor is notified after the due date. All quizzes and exams must be submitted by the due date and time.

No exceptions will be made for quizzes and exams unless explicitly stated otherwise.

ACADEMIC INTEGRITY + PLAGIARISM

Cheating, plagiarism, and any other forms of academic dishonesty will not be tolerated.

This course will follow the standards outlined by the institution. The link below outlines each standard and sanctions for academic misconduct. Once you navigate to the webpage below, click on the “Academic Integrity” tab to review standards and sanctions.

<https://catalog.luc.edu/academic-standards-regulations/undergraduate/>

ACCOMMODATIONS

Loyola University Chicago provides reasonable accommodations for students with disabilities. Any student requesting accommodations related to a disability or other condition is required to register with the Student Accessibility Center (SAC). Professors will receive an accommodation notification from SAC, preferably within the first two weeks of class.

Students are encouraged to meet with their professor individually in order to discuss their accommodations. All information will remain confidential.

Please note that in this class, software may be used to audio record class lectures in order to provide equal access to students with disabilities. Students approved for this accommodation use recordings for their personal study only and recordings may not be shared with other people or used in any way against the faculty member, other lecturers, or students whose classroom comments are recorded as part of the class activity. Recordings are deleted at the end of the semester.

For more information about registering with SAC or questions about accommodations, please contact SAC at 773-508-3700 or SAC@luc.edu.

LEARNER SUPPORT

Tech Support HelpDesk: helpdesk@luc.edu 773-508-4487

Student Accessibility Center: <http://www.luc.edu/sac/>

DISCLAIMER

This syllabus is subject to change at the instructor's discretion with prior student notification.

Updates:

8/10/2026 – Completed Syllabus for Fall 2026